

June

8

793

Victorious Vikings

Seafaring warriors and raiders from Scandinavia, known as Vikings, attacked the monastery on the island of Lindisfarne, off the coast of England. They killed the monks and looted valuables in what was the first of many raids throughout the British Isles.

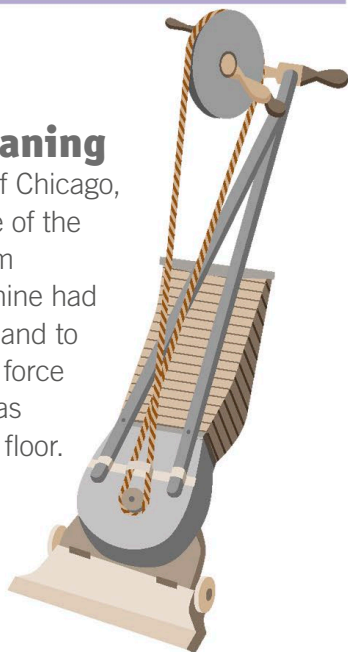
Born this day

1823 Robert Morris, Black American lawyer. One of the first Black lawyers in the USA, he challenged racial segregation in schools by filing a lawsuit against the state of Boston.

1869

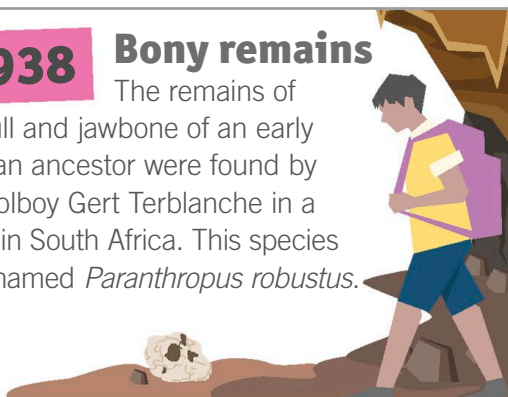
Vacuum-cleaning

Ives W McGaffey of Chicago, USA, patented one of the world's first vacuum cleaners. His machine had to be cranked by hand to generate a suction force while the device was pushed across the floor.



1938 Bony remains

The remains of a skull and jawbone of an early human ancestor were found by schoolboy Gert Terblanche in a cave in South Africa. This species was named *Paranthropus robustus*.



Also on this day

1783 The Laki volcanic fissure in Iceland erupted, spewing dangerous gases into the atmosphere. This poisonous haze spread across Europe, causing crop failure and famine.

1896 A Peugeot Victoria Type 8 was stolen in France in the first known instance of car theft.

1992 World Ocean Day was first celebrated during the Rio de Janeiro Earth Summit to raise awareness about protecting Earth's oceans.